



GIMP for Beginners, Part 6

Souping Up Photos

Welcome to the sixth instalment of tutorials on the GIMP. In this article, we will focus on improving photographs and images by using an array of effects.

Ever since the invention of the camera, people have been inquisitive about photography. However, not even the best photographers get the results they aim for, every time. To err is human, isn't it? Thus, in order to achieve a perfect blend of lighting and range, photographers thrive on photo manipulation software. The GIMP provides a wide range of tools and utilities to fix your photographs and you will be enthralled with the results. The only downside is the lack of a 32-bit high colour channel. Apart from that, the GIMP is the perfect tool to fix images.

In this tutorial, we will work on some cool techniques that are often used by photographers in order to stun viewers. The effects sure look gorgeous, while achieving

that look with the GIMP is child's play. In this tutorial, we will explore three different effects—HDR (High Dynamic Range) effect, Mask Isolation (*a la* the Sin City effect), and the Stamp effect (I like to call it that). So, let's get started.

The HDR effect

The digital rendering of HDR increases luminance of the darkest and the lightest part of a photograph or an image. The HDR effect adds to the beauty of an image by providing more depth to it. But before we proceed, we need to install a plug-in named Dodge and Burn. Grab the plug-in from the LFY CD and copy it in the `~/gimp-2.6/scripts` folder. Restart the GIMP and you should have a new menu named *Sprint Fu*.